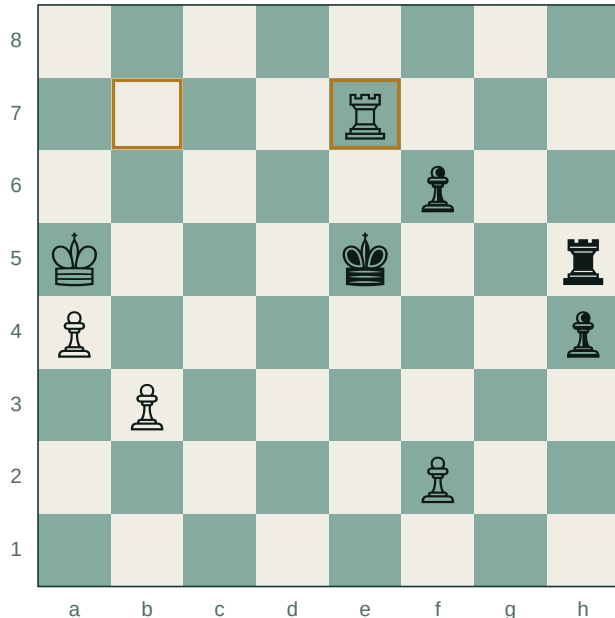


# Discovered checks: Black, move 40

Discovered checks

Black to move



Previous move: 40.Re7+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**40...Kd6+ 41. Kb4 Kxe7**

**40...Kd6+** Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. The changed line means the rook on h5 attacks the king on a5. Recorded reply: **41.Kb4**.

**41...Kxe7** The king captures the rook on e7.

At the end, nominal material is White 3 / Black 7 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -1 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A discovered check opens a line toward the king by moving the blocking piece. Because check must be answered, the moving piece may gain a free tempo for another threat.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

The defending king is on a5. Geometrically undefended: rook on e7. Check for tactical protection.